

Elvis Presley

The KING of rock and roll

Elvis Presley was a singer, film star, and cultural icon. He starred in many films and sold more than a billion records—that's why fans call him the "king."

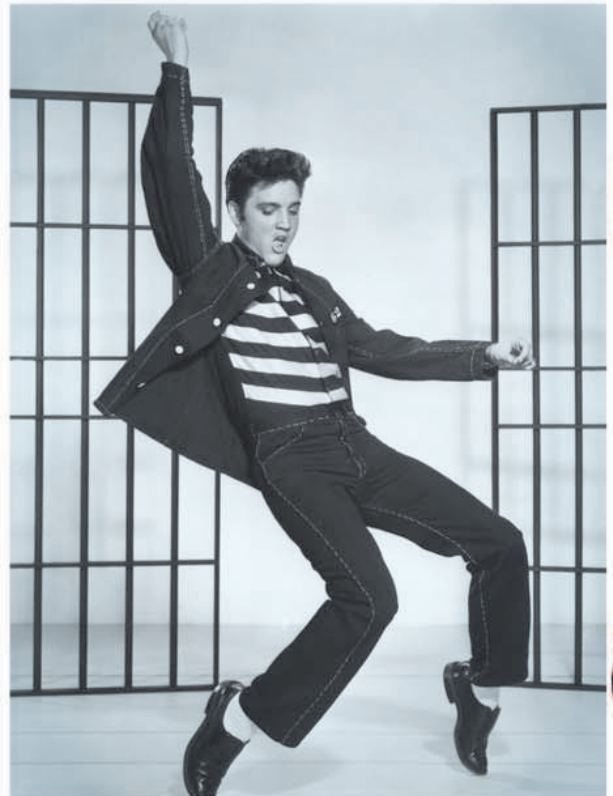


Young rocker

Elvis Aaron Presley was born in Tupelo, Mississippi, USA, in 1935. When he was just a young boy he entered a **singing competition**, but came only fifth. For his tenth birthday he was given a **GUITAR**, even though he really wanted a bicycle. He soon started taking his guitar to school and would play and sing at lunchtime.

A new sound

His first single, "*That's alright*," was released in 1954. The first time it was played on the radio, the listeners loved it so much that the DJ played it again and again for two whole hours. His unique sound that he took from traditional blues music and his **hip-shaking** dance moves were unlike anything that people had ever heard or seen before. By the time Elvis died in 1977, he had sold more than **600 MILLION** singles and albums.



He paved the way for...



With songs like "Johnny be Good" and "Roll over Beethoven," **CHUCK BERRY** (1926–) was a pioneer of rock and roll music in the 1950s.

